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2025 Reflections



Vikas Surani
Global Vice President – Growth, Strategy & Transformations | TEDx Speaker | IIMA



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Hello Curious Minds, 🙌

As the year comes to a close, I find myself doing what I've done quietly all year — reflecting.

Not in one big sitting – but in small pauses. Between meetings. ✈️ On flights. 🚶♂️ During walks. Late evenings.

I may not reflect loudly or ceremoniously — but I reflect often.

Before I go further, thank you. 🙏 The *Being Curious* community is now **2,700 strong**, and many of my strongest insights this year came from conversations with you — comments that made me pause, messages that nudged my thinking, and exchanges that stayed with me long after they ended.

A quick pause on 2024

When I closed **2024**, I called it the **Year of Habits**.

Reading. Writing. Reflection. Care. Leadership. Learning.

Nothing dramatic — just consistency.

Those habits didn't change everything overnight, but they built

something important: **inner steadiness**.

And that steadiness gave me the confidence to say one thing clearly as I entered 2025:

👉 This will be a Year of Experiences.

2025: A Year of Experiences

Looking back now, the year unfolded through experiences that worked **inward first**, then **outward**, and finally **grounded me** — personally and professionally.

And that order mattered.

Inward Experiences (What Changed Me) 🧠

Turning **40** did that naturally. It created space to pause and reflect.

So did **Vipassana** — ten days of silence, no phone, no talking. It didn't give me answers. It gave me **awareness** — of my reactions, my pace, and how powerful a pause can be.

That awareness followed me everywhere — into meetings, decisions, and difficult conversations. Quietly, but consistently.

Outward Experiences (Finding My Voice) 🎤

Some experiences asked me to step forward.

Standing on a **TEDx stage** for the first time. Speaking at forums on **AI, innovation, sustainability, and the future of work**. Writing consistently through the *Being Curious* newsletter.

None of this felt like performing. It felt like **responsibility** — to speak from lived experience, not borrowed certainty.

Learning stayed close too. Returning to the classroom at **IIM Ahmedabad**, and going deeper into **AI and leadership**, reminded me that curiosity isn't about knowing more — it's about staying open as the world keeps changing.

Professional Experiences (How I Showed Up) 🚀

Work and life blended naturally this year.

Completing **14 years at Mastek** felt meaningful — not as a milestone, but as a reminder of relationships built over time.

Launching **ADOPT AI**, contributing to **Lead with AI**, hosting **workshops and townhalls**, and helping teams navigate change — all of it felt less about staying relevant and more about staying thoughtful.

Being recognised along the way mattered:

- **True Ideator**
- **Lead with VECTOR Leader**
- **True Mastekeer**
- **Brand Champion 2.0**
- Continued responsibility as a **POSH IC member**

But being **trusted by teams** mattered more than any title. That trust is something I value deeply.

One moment captured this professionally and emotionally:

Standing at the **Bell Ringing Ceremony at the National Stock Exchange** 🛎️ [NSE India](#) Goosebumps. Gratitude. Perspective. A reminder that collective effort compounds over time.

Grounding Experiences (Staying Human) 🌍

From the **beaches of Goa** to the **desert of Jaisalmer**, from busy days in **Mumbai and Delhi NCR** to divine moments in **Ujjain and Omkareshwar**.

Our **family international trip** — Singapore and Malaysia — reminded me how differently the world looks through a child's curiosity 🧒🧒🧒🧒.

Visiting **every Mastek office across India** reinforced something simple: leadership feels more grounded when you show up in person.

What made it even more special were the moments beyond business — conversations with [Ashank Desai](#), [Ketan Mehta](#), and [R. Sundar](#) that went deeper than numbers and strategy. Conversations about values, long-term thinking, and building institutions that last.

Giving back stayed quietly woven into the year:

🌱 **Tree plantation on World Environment Day**

💰 **Social value initiatives**

❤️ **Tuesday Giving**

🎓 **Staying connected with my alma mater**

These moments didn't need announcements. They just felt right.

The One Learning of 2025

If I distil 2025 into one learning, it would be this:

▮ **Experiences shape judgment in ways plans never can.**

Looking Ahead to 2026

When I step back, the arc feels clear:

- 2024 built the habits
- 2025 expanded perspective through experiences
- 2026 now calls for transformation

Not louder goals. Not longer lists.

But **fewer, deeper choices**, more presence over pace, and moving from architecting ideas to **architecting outcomes** — at work and in life.

👉 2026 will be my Year of Transformation.

One simple way to close the year together 📌

If you had to describe your **2025 in one word**, what would it be?

Stay curious, Vikas Surani





Closing 2025 on HIGH with Love of my Life & Wishing you the BEST of 2026

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Author

Global Vice President – Growth, Strategy & Transformations | TEDx S...

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